

Child ~~sexual exploitation policy~~

Overview

October 2020

We have a zero-tolerance child sexual exploitation policy on Twitter.

Twitter has zero tolerance towards any material that features or promotes child sexual exploitation, ~~one of the most serious violations of the [Twitter Rules](https://help.twitter.com/rules-and-policies/twitter-rules).~~

This may include media, text, illustrated, or computer-generated ~~images.~~

Regardless of the intent, viewing, sharing, or linking to child sexual exploitation material contributes to the re-victimization of the depicted children. This also applies to content that may further contribute to victimization of children through the promotion or glorification of child sexual exploitation. ~~For the purposes of this policy, a minor is any person under the age of 18.~~

What is in violation of this policy?

Any content that depicts or promotes child sexual exploitation ~~including, but not limited to:~~

Child safety

May 2024

We have zero tolerance for any forms of child sexual exploitation and remove certain media depicting physical child abuse to prevent the normalization of violence against children.

Our Child Safety policy is designed to protect minors from sexual and physical abuse, as well as psychological harm that may result from sharing such content. With this principle in mind, Child Safety content is any content that contains Child Sexual Exploitation, Physical Child Abuse Media and Media of Minors in Physical Altercation, as defined below.

We encourage our users to come to X to share stories, raise awareness, and speak their mind - including calling attention to the exploitation of children and minors. However, even when shared with the intent to bring awareness or justice, to express outrage or sharing content in a humoristic context, posting media of children experiencing sexual abuse or certain types of physical abuse can contribute to their revictimization and may even lead to the normalization of sexual or physical violence against children. When this content is shared on X, we may remove it even if it was shared with good intent. Our priority is to protect minors from physical and psychological harm irrespective of the context in which the content may be shared.

We use the terms children and minors interchangeably in any of our policies and define them as any person under the age of 18.

Child Sexual Exploitation

X has zero tolerance towards any material that features or promotes child sexual exploitation.

This may include real media, text, illustrated, or computer-generated media - including generative AI media.

Regardless of the intent, anyone viewing, sharing, linking, or engaging with any kind of child sexual exploitation material contributes to the re-victimization of the depicted children and puts children at an extreme risk of being harmed. This also applies to content that may further contribute to victimization of children through the promotion or glorification of child sexual exploitation.

Learn more

Not allowed

Any content that depicts or promotes child sexual exploitation is strictly prohibited on X. This includes, but is not limited to, directly or indirectly sharing, requesting, linking to, engaging with (such as liking or reposting, or following accounts that distribute), expressing a desire for, or describing:

- ~~visual~~ depictions of a child engaging in sexually explicit or sexually suggestive acts;
- ~~illustrated, computer-generated or other forms of realistic depictions of a human child in a sexually explicit context, or engaging in sexually explicit acts;~~
- sexualized commentaries about or directed at a known or unknown minor; ~~and~~
- links to third-party sites that host child sexual exploitation material.

~~The following behaviors are also not permitted:~~

- ~~• sharing~~ fantasies about or promoting engagement in child sexual exploitation;
- ~~• expressing a desire to obtain materials that feature child sexual exploitation;~~
- ~~• engaging or trying to engage a child in a sexually explicit conversation;~~

- identifying alleged victims of childhood sexual exploitation by name or image; ~~and~~
- promoting or normalizing sexual attraction to minors as a form of identity or sexual orientation.
- sending sexually explicit media to a child;
- trying to obtain sexually explicit media from a child or trying to engage a child in sexual activity through blackmail or other incentives;
- recruiting, advertising or expressing an interest in a commercial sex act involving a child, or in harboring and/or transporting a child for sexual purposes;

What is not a violation of this policy?

- Discussions related to child sexual exploitation ~~are permitted, provided they don't normalise, promote or glorify child sexual exploitation in any way;~~
- Conversations about help-seeking behaviour of individuals who may struggle with an attraction to minors;
- Advocacy against illegal or harmful activity involving minors provided there is no sharing of, or linking to any material featuring child sexual exploitation; ~~and~~
- ~~• Depictions of nude minors in a non-sexualized context or setting may be permitted in a limited number of scenarios (e.g., art works by internationally renowned artists that feature minors, news media reportage, media created and shared for scientific or educational purposes).~~

Who can report violations of this policy?

~~Anyone can report potential violations of this policy, whether they have a Twitter account or not.~~

How can I report violations of this policy?

~~If you think you've found a Twitter account distributing or promoting child sexual exploitation, [you can report it via our child sexual exploitation form](https://help.twitter.com/forms/cse). Provide the username and links to all relevant Tweets that led you to believe the account should be reviewed.~~

What happens if you violate this policy?

~~In the majority of cases, the consequence for violating our child sexual~~

- depictions of a child engaging in sexually explicit or suggestive acts, **which may include edits of such media, such as obscuring faces or body parts;**
- sexualized commentaries about or directed at a known (or unknown) minor;
- links to third-party sites that host child sexual exploitation materials of any kind; **and**
- **fantasies about or promoting engagement in child sexual exploitation.**

Additionally, we prohibit any of the following:

- identifying alleged victims of childhood sexual exploitation by name or image;
- promoting or normalizing sexual attraction to minors as a form of identity or sexual orientation;
- sending sexually explicit media to a child, **or engaging or trying to engage a child in a sexually explicit conversation;**
- trying to obtain sexually explicit media from a child, or trying to engage a child in sexual activity through blackmail or other incentives;
- recruiting, advertising or expressing an interest in a commercial sex act involving a child, or in harboring and/or transporting a child for sexual purposes; **and**
- **threatening to share, or requesting that others share sexual media of minors, including self-generated sexual media of minors, particularly when engaging in blackmail or bounty tactics.**

Allowed

- We will make very limited exceptions to content related to child sexual exploitation only where there is a low risk of direct harm to the minor(s):**
- discussion related to child sexual exploitation **that does not promote or glorify child sexual exploitation in any way or identify the potential victim;**
 - conversations about help-seeking behavior of individuals who may struggle with an attraction to minors; **and**
 - advocacy against illegal or harmful activity involving minors, provided there is no sharing of, or linking to any material featuring child sexual exploitation.

- **victims sharing their stories, provided they do not contain explicit details or media;**

For violations of our Child Sexual Exploitation policy:

- **in the majority of cases, users will be immediately and permanently suspended;**

exploitation policy is immediate and permanent suspension. In addition, violators will be prohibited from creating any new accounts in the future.

Note: when we're made aware of content depicting or promoting child sexual exploitation, including links to third party sites where this content can be accessed, they will be removed without further notice and reported to the National Center for Missing & Exploited Children (NCMEC).

In a limited number of situations, where we haven't identified any malicious intent, we will require you to remove this content. We will also temporarily lock you out of your account before you can Tweet again. Further violations will lead to your account being permanently suspended. If you believe that your account was suspended in error, you can [submit an appeal.](https://help.twitter.com/forms/general?subtopic=suspended)

Additional resources

Learn more about our [range of enforcement options](https://help.twitter.com/rules-and-policies/enforcement-options) and our approach to [policy development and enforcement](https://help.twitter.com/rules-and-policies/enforcement-philosophy).

If you've found content elsewhere on the internet that is distributing or promoting child sexual exploitation, you should [file a report with NCMEC](http://www.missingkids.org/gethelpnow/cybertipline), or with your local law enforcement. If you believe the content is hosted on a website outside of the United States, you can report it on the [International Association of Internet Hotlines website](https://www.inhope.org/EN# hotlineReferral).

We partner with multiple organisations whose work is dedicated to fighting child sexual exploitation around the world. Please see the full list of [our child protection partners](https://about.twitter.com/safety/safety-partners.html#child-protection-partners).

- additionally, when we're made aware of content depicting or promoting child sexual exploitation, including links to third party sites where this content can be accessed, the accounts sharing this content will be reported to the National Center for Missing & Exploited Children (NCMEC); and
- for certain violations, we may instead require post removal. For example, we may ask someone to remove the violating content. Subsequent violations may lead to account suspension.

Physical Child Abuse Media

To prevent the revictimization or normalization of violence against children, we will remove most instances of media depicting physical child abuse, even if shared to raise awareness or express outrage.

When assessing the best course of action to take, we consider:

- whether the child is nude, partially clothed, or fully clothed;
- the severity of harm the child is experiencing; and
- whether the media was shared with abusive, non-abusive, or newsworthy context.

Learn more

Not allowed

With the above criteria in mind, we are more likely to remove any media:

- where the child is nude and experiencing any type of harm;
- shared with abusive context; and
- where the child is experiencing moderate or major harm.

Restricted reach

We will make limited exceptions to media depicting physical child abuse in certain circumstances, such as:

- when the media is being shared to identify the child in order to rescue them from the abusive situation, or identify the perpetrator; and
- when the media is being shared by news organizations.

If we decide to allow this media on the platform, we will require it to be placed behind our Graphic Content warning.

For violations of our Physical Child Abuse Media policy, we may:

Make the content less visible on X by:

- applying a content warning; or
- requiring post removal. For example, we may ask someone to remove the violating content and serve a period of time in read-only mode before they can post again. Subsequent violations may lead to account suspension.

Suspend accounts whose sole purpose appears to be to engage in the types of behavior prohibited above.

Media of Minors in Physical Altercation

We aim to protect the wellbeing of minors involved in physical altercation, regardless of their status (i.e victim or aggressor), while balancing the need to raise awareness of these issues. When assessing the best course of action to take, we may consider whether:

- the content is shared with an abusive or non-abusive context;
- we have received a report from the minor or an authorized representative; and
- the content is excessively graphic.

Learn more

Restricted reach

We will make limited exceptions to media depicting children in physical altercation in certain circumstances, such as when the media is being shared by news organizations. If we decide to allow this media on the platform, we may require it to be placed behind a content warning.

For violations of our Media of Minors is Physical Altercation policy:

- We may require post removal upon receiving a report from the minor or an authorized representative. For example, we may ask someone to remove the violating content and serve a period of time in read-only mode before they can post again. Subsequent violations may lead to account suspension;
- when sharing content that is abusive towards the victim [Abusive Behavior] (<https://help.twitter.com/en/rules-and-policies/abusive-behavior>) policies may apply; and
- when sharing content that is Graphic or includes Gratuitous Gore, our [Sensitive Media] (<https://help.twitter.com/en/rules-and-policies/media-policy>) policies may apply.

How to Report

Anyone can report violations of this policy using our dedicated in-app reporting flow or via our [Help Center] (<https://help.twitter.com/en/forms/safety-and-sensitive-content/cse>). An X account is not needed to report potential violations.

If you believe a child is at immediate risk of harm or death, please reach out to your local law enforcement. Additionally, after reporting potential violations of our Child Sexual Exploitation policy to us, you can also notify the National Center for Missing & Exploited Children (NCMEC) by using their [CyberTipline] (<https://report.cybertip.org/>) portal or calling 1-800-843-5678.

Note : it can be illegal to engage with content that violates our Child Sexual Exploitation policy. Please be sure to report the content right away and do not like, reply to, quote-post, screenshot, follow accounts who

distribute, or otherwise engage with the content; We do not require you to provide evidence of the potential violation in your report.

Appeals

If you believe we made a mistake, you can [submit an appeal](<https://help.twitter.com/en/forms/account-access/appeals.html>).

More Information

We are constantly seeking feedback and input from trusted organizations that are aligned in the mission to combat online child sexual exploitation. To learn more about our partnerships [read the update on our work to tackle Child Sexual Exploitation on X](https://blog.x.com/en_us/topics/company/2023/an-update-on-our-work-to-tackle-child-sexual-exploitation-on-x).